

THEFAB COOKBOOK - VOLUME I

Pasta and Sage

Such an easy dish, but full of the love of an Italian family table: good pasta, butter, garlic, chili, pepper, and a generous handful of sage slowly warmed until the whole kitchen smells like home.

Serves 2-4	Prep 5 min	Cook 12 min	Style Simple Italian comfort
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TheFAB studio note

This recipe is not about complexity. The secret is patience: let the butter, garlic, chili and sage grill slowly, without burning, then let the pasta finish in the pan so it becomes glossy and perfumed.

Ingredients

- 320-400 g of your preferred pasta: spaghetti, linguine, tagliatelle, rigatoni or penne
- 80-100 g good butter
- 2 garlic cloves, finely sliced or lightly crushed
- 1 small fresh chili pepper, finely sliced, or a pinch of dried chili flakes
- A very generous handful of fresh sage leaves, roughly torn
- Optional: 1 small rosemary sprig, used with restraint
- Sea salt for the pasta water and for final seasoning
- Freshly ground black pepper
- A little reserved pasta cooking water
- Optional at the table: Parmesan or Pecorino, freshly grated

Method

- 1** Bring a large pot of salted water to the boil. Cook the pasta al dente, according to the packet instructions. Before draining, reserve a cup of the cooking water.
- 2** While the pasta cooks, melt the butter in a large pan over gentle heat. Add the garlic, chili, plenty of black pepper, the sage leaves, and the rosemary if using.
- 3** Let everything grill slowly in the butter. The garlic should become fragrant, the sage slightly crisp, and the butter lightly nutty - but nothing should burn.
- 4** Add the drained pasta directly into the pan. Toss well, adding a splash of pasta water to create a silky sauce that coats every piece of pasta.
- 5** Taste, adjust with salt, and finish with more pepper and a few fresh sage leaves if you like. Serve immediately, straight from the pan spirit.

Proposed wine pairing

A pairing for butter, sage and garlic should bring freshness, lift the herbs, and keep the dish light rather than heavy.

Best match	Soave Classico or Verdicchio dei Castelli di Jesi.
Also works	Vermentino, Friulano, Pinot Grigio from Friuli, or a dry Italian sparkling wine such as Franciacorta Brut.
For red lovers	A light, fresh red served slightly cool: Bardolino, Valpolicella Classico, or a young Chianti with gentle tannins.
Why it works	The acidity cuts through the butter, while herbal and almond-like notes in Italian whites echo the sage without overpowering the simplicity of the dish.
Serving note	Avoid heavy, oaky whites or very tannic reds. This is a delicate family dish: the wine should refresh the palate and let the sage stay in front.

Personal adjustment: when a recipe has only a few ingredients, quality becomes the recipe. Use the best butter you have, fresh sage, and a pasta shape you truly love.